

# Exhibit*Guide*

A smart audio & content guide for museums and galleries. Visitors scan the exhibit label with their own phone — no hardware rental, no app install, no account — and get the story behind the work, their way.

Progressive Web App

QR scan — no app install

B2B2C — institutions subscribe

## *I.* SCAN

A QR code on any exhibit label opens the page instantly — no app, no install.

## *II.* READ OR LISTEN

A 30-second TLDR up front; text, audio, video and imagery on demand.

## *III.* CATALOGUE

Optionally save exhibits to a personal collection to revisit after the visit.

JOHANNES VERMEER

*Girl with a Pearl  
Earring, c. 1665*

Oil on canvas · 44.5 × 39 cm



*Scan for the story —*

*thirty seconds, or as  
deep as you like.*

## Visitors arrive curious and connected – the *storytelling* hasn't caught up.

Galleries are busier than ever and nearly every visitor already carries a capable smartphone. Yet the tools to explain the work are still a printed label of forty words or a rented handset behind a queue. **The phone in the pocket is the opportunity.**

~90%

of gallery visitors carry a smartphone capable of scanning a QR code.

Illustrative — smartphone penetration

1 in 5

visitors rent an audio handset; cost, queues and hygiene deter the rest.

Illustrative — handset uptake

~60%

say wall labels are too short — they want more depth, on their terms.

Illustrative — visitor surveys

2<sub>sec</sub>

is all the patience a visitor gives a page mid-visit before moving on.

Web performance benchmarks

### THREE FORCES CONVERGING

#### QR went mainstream

Menus and tickets normalised scanning — no instruction needed anymore.

#### App fatigue is real

Nobody installs a single-visit app or signs up at the gallery door.

#### Institutions want reach

Curators have rich content but no engineering team to publish it.

## What it actually *feels like* to use, start to finish.



**Maya, 28**, is on a weekend city break with an hour spare at the Mauritshuis. She loves art but isn't an expert, her phone is nearly full, and she'd never download an app for a single visit.

### 14:02 · STANDS

#### *In front of the work*

The printed label gives forty words. She wants the story, not a queue for a handset.

### 14:03 · SCANS

#### *Her own phone*

Camera reads the QR on the mount. One tap opens the page — no app, no sign-up.

### 14:03 · SKIMS

#### *The 30-second TLDR*

She gets the gist instantly, then taps to go deeper on the parts that intrigue her.

### 14:06 · LISTENS

#### *Hands-free narration*

Audio plays in her earphones so her eyes stay on the painting, not the screen.

### 19:40 · REVISITS

#### *Saved, on the train home*

She'd tapped "save" — now reads the full provenance and keeps it in her collection.

### THE USP

*No rental counter, no app store, no sign-up wall — and yet more depth and a record to take home than any current option offers.*

## Three kinds of visitor shaped every *design choice*.

*Maya* 28

### THE TIME-PRESSED TOURIST

#### DEMOGRAPHICS

International visitor, short stay, mobile-first, on patchy gallery WiFi.

#### PSYCHOGRAPHICS

Curious but time-poor; wants the gist, not a guided tour or commitment.

#### BEHAVIOUR

Scans, skims the TLDR, listens while looking, moves on within minutes.

*David* 54

### THE LIFELONG LEARNER

#### DEMOGRAPHICS

Local member, frequent visitor, comfortable with technology and depth.

#### PSYCHOGRAPHICS

Enjoys context and technique; values quality content over novelty.

#### BEHAVIOUR

Lingers, plays full audio, watches the film, returns across many visits.

*Aisha* 23

### THE STUDENT & RESEARCHER

#### DEMOGRAPHICS

Art-history student; visits with academic intent and a reading list.

#### PSYCHOGRAPHICS

Rigorous; needs sources she can trust, quote and revisit later.

#### BEHAVIOUR

Saves pieces, attaches notes, exports citation-ready records after the visit.

### The curator

#### SECONDARY — THE PAYING CUSTOMER

Small-to-mid institutions with rich content but no engineering team. They publish exhibits from a simple CMS and subscribe per institution — the people who shape demographics, psychographics *and* the business model alike.

## One MVP — read free, then *save, annotate and manage*.

### READ CORE

MVP

#### Scan to story — no login

*The validated core — built and piloted first*

- **QR scanning** — camera opens the PWA page directly
- **Exhibit page** — 30-sec TLDR + expandable full content
- **READ in 3 formats** — text, audio narration, short film
- **Format preference** — remembered across exhibits
- **PWA + offline** — cached for patchy gallery WiFi
- **Operator CMS** — curators publish via Django admin

### ACCOUNTS & COLLECTIONS

MVP · CRUD

#### Save, annotate, manage

*Account gate appears only at save*

- **Accounts** — email register, login, logout, reset
- **Create** — save an exhibit into a collection
- **Read** — re-open saved content after the visit
- **Update** — annotate pieces; rename collections
- **Delete** — remove a saved exhibit or collection

### LATER PHASES

POST-MVP

#### Sequenced after the pilot

*Built once the core is validated*

- **AI layer** — Claude TLDRs, translation, related works
- **Accessibility mode** — simplified language, richer audio
- **Operator analytics** — engagement & dwell per exhibit
- **SSO** — Google / Apple (data-policy dependent)
- **Export & history** — PDF / text; passive visit log
- **Async & CMS+** — Celery + Redis · Wagtail upgrade

## Six people, one gallery, *one scan each*.

### QR DEEP-LINK · NO ACCOUNT

*As a first-time visitor,*

**I WANT** exhibit pages to open straight from my camera,

**SO THAT** I never install an app or sign up mid-visit.

### TLDR SUMMARY

*As a time-pressed tourist,*

**I WANT** a thirty-second summary the moment I scan,

**SO THAT** I get the story without breaking my stride.

### AUDIO · FORMAT PREFERENCE

*As a visitor absorbed in the work,*

**I WANT** narration to play in my earphones,

**SO THAT** I learn without taking my eyes off the piece.

### COLLECTIONS · CREATE + UPDATE

*As an academic researcher,*

**I WANT** to save exhibits and annotate them with my own notes,

**SO THAT** I can study what I saw after the visit.

### LOGIN · POST-VISIT RETURN

*As a returning visitor,*

**I WANT** to log in and re-open my saved collection,

**SO THAT** I pick up exactly where I left off after the visit.

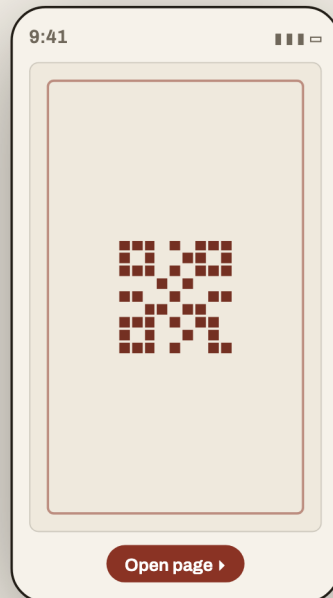
### MUSEUM CMS

*As a curator,*

**I WANT** to publish exhibit content from a simple CMS,

**SO THAT** I update the gallery without engineering help.

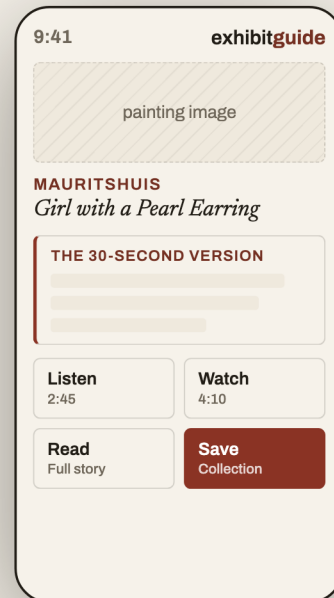
## Early sketches: from the painting to a saved piece in *four taps*.



*i.*

### Scan

Camera reads the QR on the mount — no app, no install.



*ii.*

### Choose

TLDR up top; listen, watch, read or save — all without signing in.



*iii.*

### Listen

Hands-free narration so eyes stay on the work, not the phone.



*iv.*

### Save

The only sign-up gate — and only once the value is clear.

## Agile in one-week sprints, on a stack chosen for *friction-free delivery*.

### Development method **AGILE — SCRUM FLAVOUR**

Wireframes mapped to user stories; a prioritised feature backlog; a demoable increment presented every Thursday, with UAT in a real gallery from Sprint 2.

### Version control **GITHUB**

Feature-branch workflow — each branch maps to a backlog item and sprint deliverable; pull-request review; main always deployable.

### BUILD ORDER — CONTENT FIRST, PUBLIC READ PILOTED, THEN AUTH & COLLECTION CRUD

|                                                               |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                |                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>TUE</b> Kick-off<br>Project understanding & scope sign-off | <b>SPRINT 01</b> Epic 0<br>Scaffold: Django + DRF + Postgres + React PWA, data model · wireframes & backlog | <b>SPRINT 02</b> Epics 1–2<br>Operator CMS + public READ — scan → content in 3 formats · pilot in a real gallery | <b>SPRINT 03</b> Epics 3–5<br>Accounts (JWT) + collections create, read & update (annotations) | <b>SPRINT 04</b> Epics 6–7<br>Delete + PWA offline · UAT findings & polish |
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### TECHNOLOGY STACK — WHY EACH LAYER · later: Celery/Redis, Claude API, Wagtail, SSO

|                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                          |                                                                                                    |                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Frontend</i><br><b>React PWA + Tailwind</b><br>Mobile-first; service-worker caching for patchy WiFi; no install. | <i>API</i><br><b>Django REST Framework</b><br>One clean REST layer for the PWA today and the CMS later. | <i>Backend + CMS</i><br><b>Django + admin</b><br>Batteries-included; the admin is the MVP CMS (Wagtail later). | <i>Auth</i><br><b>dj-rest-auth + JWT</b><br>Register, login, logout, reset out of the box; SSO deferred. | <i>Database</i><br><b>PostgreSQL</b><br>Exhibits, accounts, collections, annotations, scan events. | <i>Media</i><br><b>S3-compatible + CDN</b><br>Audio, video & images; audio < 1 MB, served fast in galleries. |
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# Engagement proves the visit; *institution renewal* proves the business.

**NORTH STAR** *Engaged scans per exhibit, per institution — the one number that shows a visitor got value and gives a curator a reason to renew.*

## VISITOR VALUE — DOES THE EXPERIENCE WORK?

### REACH

Scan-through *rate*  
% of scans that open the page  
Source — scan events ÷ page loads

### ACTIVATION

Scan → content  
Primary: < 2 s, live gallery  
Source — Sentry / Web Vitals

### DEPTH

Format *engagement*  
Split: audio · video · text  
Source — PostHog

### LOYALTY

Save & *return*  
Save conv · post-visit re-open  
A depth signal — not a vanity count

## BUSINESS VALUE — WHY A MUSEUM INVESTS, AND RENEWS

### OPERATOR

Publish *time*  
Minutes to publish an exhibit  
Source — CMS timestamps

### PROVEN ROI

Engagement *per exhibit*  
The renewal argument  
Source — operator dashboard

### RETENTION

Institution *renewal*  
The growth metric (NRR)  
Source — subscriptions

### EXPANSION

New sites & *referrals*  
Curators talk to curators  
Source — pipeline / CRM

### THE FLYWHEEL

Most visitors come **once** — so chasing consumer DAU or 7-day retention would mislead. Engaged visitors make curators look good; **curators see the ROI and renew**; renewals and referrals grow the network — which brings more visitors.

Instrumented privacy-first: PostHog (self-hosted per tenant) · Plausible (cookieless) · Sentry / Web Vitals · Metabase dashboards for curators.

# Thank you — *your turn.*

I'd value feedback on scope and on the friction-free, account-light approach — and approval to begin the Sprint 1 build of the scan-to-story MVP.

## FOR YOUR APPROVAL

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- i.* Is the MVP scope right?  
READ-first core, then full collection CRUD; AI & export deferred.
- ii.* Is the audience well-targeted?  
Tourist, learner, researcher — plus the curator who pays.
- iii.* Any concerns on the stack?  
React PWA + DRF/Django, QR-first, JWT auth, Django-admin CMS.